

WEEK 1: INTRODUCTION TO BSA & UNDERSTANDING THE ENTERPRISE

Course: Business Systems Analysis

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Faculty: Faculty of Technology

Learning Objectives

By the end of this session, students will be able to:

- **Explain** the role of a Business Systems Analyst in technology projects.
- **Distinguish** a business-first perspective from a solution-first perspective.
- **Describe** the key characteristics of an enterprise and its business operations.
- **Understand** the assigned enterprise scenario and its business context.
- **Prepare** an initial stakeholder investigation plan for the project.

Business Mindset vs. Dev Mindset (The Core Shift)

DEV MINDSET (Inside-Out)

Tech Stack:

- Focus on "What code, database, or framework to use?"

System Logic:

- Focus on "Is this feature hard or complex to write?"

Software Bug:

- Focus on "System crashed or thrown an exception."

BUSINESS MINDSET (Outside-In)

Business Goal:

- Focus on "What business pain point are we solving?"

Financial ROI:

- Focus on "Does this feature reduce cost or save time?"

Business Pain:

- Focus on "Money lost, slow operations, or human error."

BA Rule of Thumb: Code is just a tool. A features-rich software that doesn't solve an operational problem is a **failed product**.

Why 70% of Software Projects Fail?

The Reality: Projects fail NOT because of bad code, but because developers build the wrong thing.

Dev vs. Business Mindset:

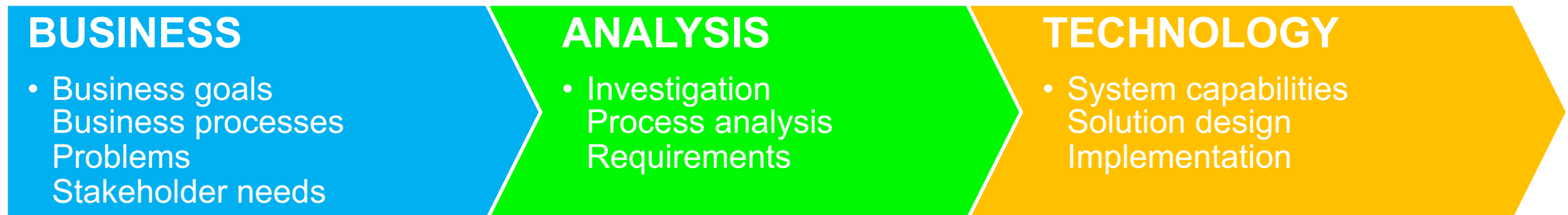
Devs focus on: *Database, Code, UI Components, Functionalities.*
Business focuses on: *Revenue, Cost Reduction, Process Speed, Human Errors.*

What Is Business Systems Analysis?

Business Systems Analysis

- Business Systems Analysis is the process of **understanding business needs and translating them into requirements for technology-supported solutions.**

A Business Systems Analyst connects:



BA Perspective

- A BA does not simply ask **“What system should we build?”**
- A BA first asks **“What does the business need, and why?”**

What Does a Business Systems Analyst Do?

- A BA helps an organization answer four fundamental questions:

Question	BA Activity
What is happening?	Understand the business
What is wrong?	Identify and analyze problems
What is needed?	Define business and system requirements
How can technology help?	Evaluate and communicate solutions

- **Typical BA Activities**
 - Understand business context
 - Identify stakeholders
 - Investigate business processes
 - Analyze business problems
 - Identify information needs
 - Define requirements
 - Model processes and use cases
 - Validate solutions with stakeholders
- **Key Idea**
 - *A BA connects business reality with technology solutions.*

The Mindset Shift: Solution-First vs. Business-First

- Two Ways to Approach a Technology Project

Solution-First Thinking	Business-First Thinking
“What software should we use?”	“What problem are we solving?”
“What feature should we build?”	“What does the business need?”
“How do we implement it?”	“How does the business work today?”
Focuses on technology capabilities	Focuses on business operations
Starts with the solution	Starts with the business

Example

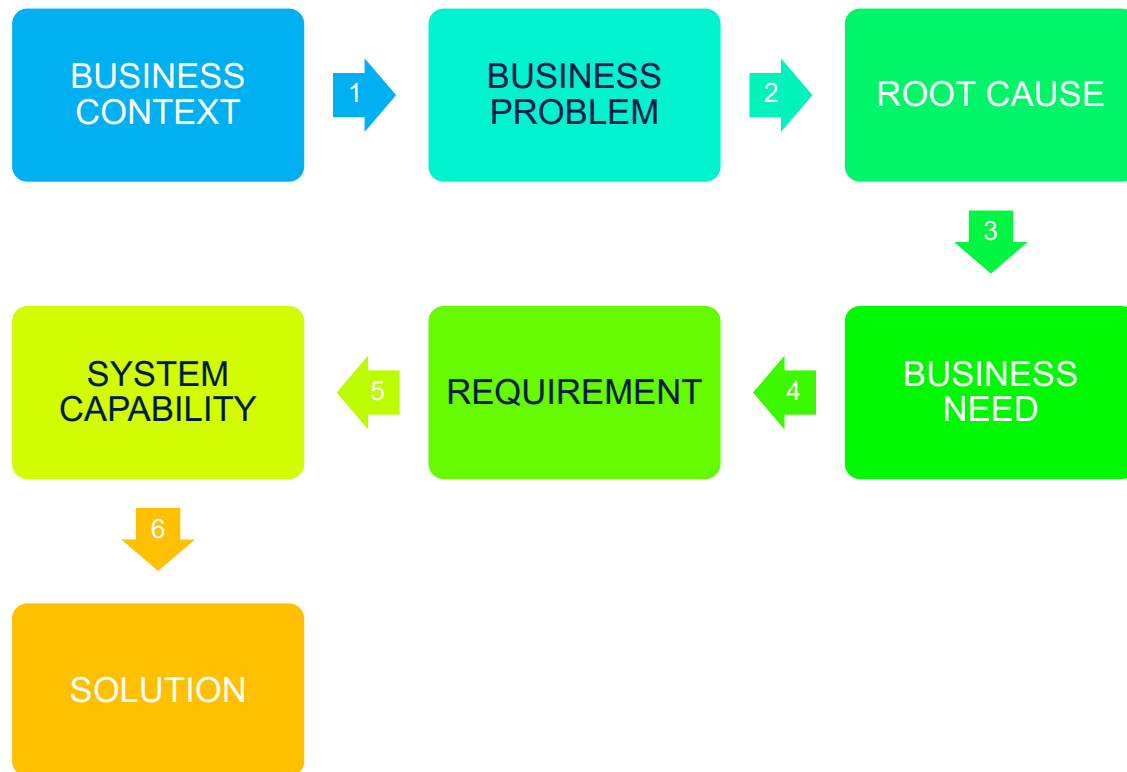
- Solution-first:**
 - “We should implement an ERP system.”
- Business-first:**
 - “Sales cannot reliably determine product availability when confirming customer orders. Why does this happen?”

Golden Rule

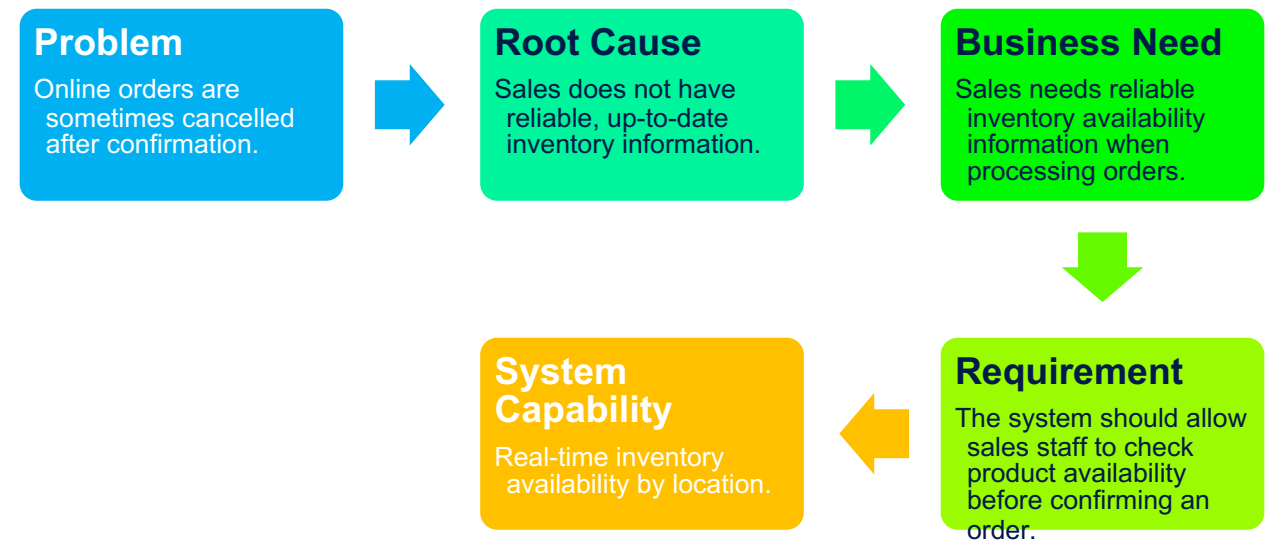
- Understand the business before deciding how technology should support it.*

The BA Thinking Process

- From Business Problem to Technology Solution



- Example



- Important**
 - Do not jump from "Problem" directly to "Solution."*

What Is an Enterprise?

Enterprise

- An enterprise is an organization that combines **people, processes, resources, information, and technology** to achieve business objectives.

An enterprise typically has:



BA Perspective

- A technology solution operates ***within an enterprise***, not in isolation.

Understanding Business Functions

- An enterprise may contain several **business functions**.
- Example — Retail Enterprise

Business Function	Typical Activities
Sales	Customer orders, pricing, quotations
Inventory	Receiving, storing, transferring stock
Purchasing	Supplier selection, ordering, replenishment
Fulfillment	Picking, packing, delivery
Accounting	Invoicing, payments, reconciliation
Customer Service	Complaints, returns, customer support
Management	Planning, monitoring, decision-making

Important

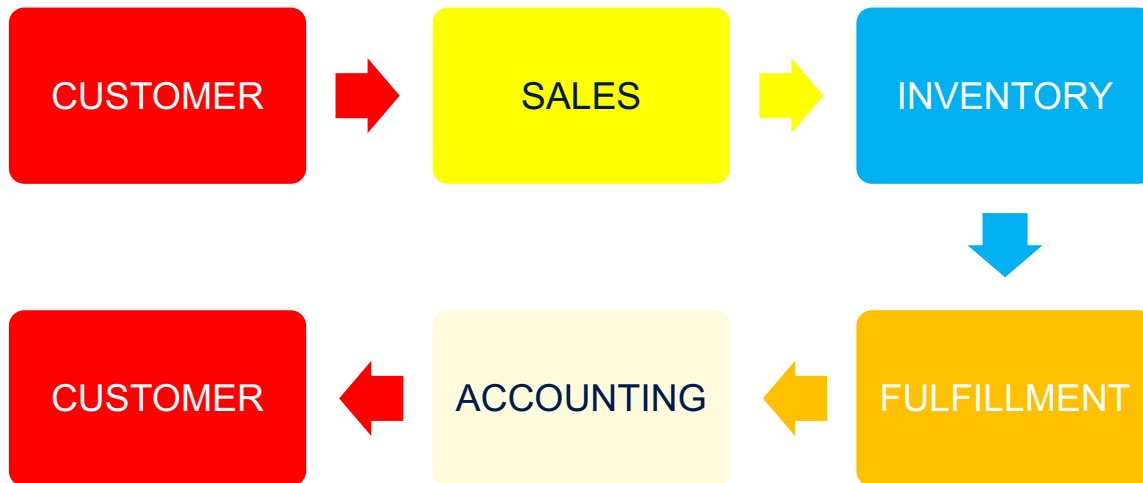
- Business functions are **connected**, not isolated.

For example: A Customer Order May Cross Multiple Business Functions

- 1 Customer places order
- 2 Sales confirms order
- 3 Warehouse checks & prepares products
- 4 Fulfillment delivers order
- 5 Accounting issues invoice & records payment
- 6 Customer receives the order

Think in End-to-End Business Processes

- **A Business Function $\neq$ A Complete Process**
- A customer order may cross several functions:



Why does this matter to a BA?

- A problem may occur **between functions**, not inside one function.

Example

- Sales says:
 - “Warehouse information is not updated.”
- Warehouse says:
 - “Sales confirms orders before checking with us.”
- The BA should not immediately decide who is right.

BA Question

- *“What actually happens between these functions?”*

Your Project Scenario

One Team = One Enterprise

Each team will investigate **one complete enterprise scenario**.

The team is responsible for understanding:

- The business model
- Customers and suppliers
- Products/services
- Business functions
- Key processes
- Stakeholders
- Business problems
- Information needs

Your Role

- **You are a Business Analyst investigating the enterprise.**

You are **not**:

- A software developer
- An Odoo consultant
- A database designer
- A system administrator

Technology comes later.

Primary Investigation Focus

Individual Responsibility Within a Team

Each student will have a **Primary Investigation Focus**.

This creates individual responsibility without dividing the enterprise into isolated modules.

- **Example**

Student	Primary Focus	Primary Stakeholder
A	Sales & Customer Orders	Sales Manager
B	Inventory & Warehouse	Warehouse Manager
C	Purchasing & Replenishment	Purchasing Manager
D	Accounting & Payments	Accounting Manager
E	Customer Experience / Management	Business Owner / Customer

Important Principle

- *Your focus is not your boundary.*

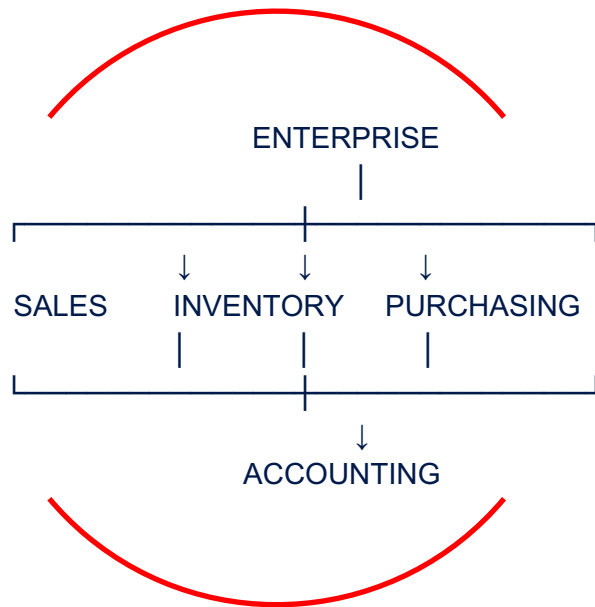
You are expected to understand how your area connects with other parts of the business.

Focus vs. Ownership

You investigate one area deeply.

But:

The team analyzes the business as a whole.



Therefore:

- **Individual**

- Deep investigation of a primary area

- **Group**

- Integration of findings across the enterprise

Goal

- Every student develops BA skills, while the team develops one coherent view of the enterprise.

Who Should a BA Talk To?

Stakeholders

- Stakeholders are people or groups who **affect, are affected by, or have an interest in** the business process or proposed solution.

Examples

- Business Owner / Manager
- Sales Manager
- Sales Staff
- Warehouse Staff
- Purchasing Staff
- Accountant
- Customer
- Supplier

Important

Different stakeholders may have:

- Different responsibilities
- Different information
- Different priorities
- Different perceptions of the same problem

BA Principle

- *Do not assume that one stakeholder represents the whole business.*

Assumption vs. Evidence

Before the Interview

- You may have an assumption:
 - “Sales probably checks inventory before confirming an order.”

After the Interview

- You may discover:
 - “Sales usually checks an Excel spreadsheet and sometimes contacts Warehouse.”

BA Principle

- *An assumption is not a fact.*

During the project, distinguish between:

Type	Meaning
Case Information	Information provided by the project scenario
Assumption	What you currently believe may be true
Interview Evidence	What a stakeholder actually tells you
Analysis	Your interpretation of the evidence
Requirement	What the business/system needs

Good BA Practice

- *Ask first. Conclude later.*

Preparing for Stakeholder Interviews

Before interviewing, define:

1

1. Who?

Who can provide relevant information?

2

2. What?

What do we need to understand?

3

3. Why?

Why is this information important?

Prepare questions about:

- Current activities
- Responsibilities
- Information used
- Systems/tools used
- Problems and exceptions
- Delays
- Handoffs
- Information gaps
- Business impact

Avoid starting with:

- ❌ "What software do you want?"

Instead ask:

- ✅ "How do you currently handle this activity?"

Your First BA Interview

Example

- You are investigating **online customer orders**.



BA Skill

- Good analysis starts with good questions.*

Project Roadmap

- Where Are We Going?

WEEK 1

Understand the Enterprise & Business Scope

WEEK 2

Interview Stakeholders & Elicitation

WEEK 3

Model AS-IS Processes

WEEK 4–8

Analyze Problems & Define Requirements

WEEK 9

Mid-term Assessment (Project Phase 1 Review)

WEEK 10–13

Use Cases, Prototyping & Solution Specification

WEEK 14–15

Final Project Presentations & BRD Defense

Week 1 Project Tasks

GROUP TASK

Your team will:

1. Confirm your enterprise scenario

- Understand the business context provided.

2. Create an Enterprise Profile

- Identify:
 - Business type
 - Products/services
 - Customers
 - Sales channels
 - Locations
 - Main business functions

3. Identify initial stakeholders

- Create an initial stakeholder map.

4. Identify investigation areas

- Assign each student a Primary Investigation Focus.

Individual Deliverable

• BA Investigation Preparation

Each student submits a short **Week 1 Investigation Plan**.

Task 1 — Investigation Focus

- Identify your primary business area.

Task 2 — Initial Understanding

Based on the case, describe:

- What this area appears to do
- Who may be involved
- What information may be needed

Task 3 — Stakeholder

- Identify your primary stakeholder.

Task 4 — Interview Questions

- Prepare **5–7 initial questions** for the Week 2 interview.

Task 5 — Initial Assumptions

- List **2–3 things you currently assume but need to verify**.
- **Your assumptions will be tested during the interview**

Group Deliverables & Definition of Done

Enterprise Profile & Investigation Map

- **Artifact 1 — Enterprise Profile**
 - A concise overview of your assigned enterprise.
- **Artifact 2 — Stakeholder Map**
 - Key stakeholders and their relationship to the business.
- **Artifact 3 — Investigation Focus Matrix**

Student	Primary Focus	Stakeholder	Investigation Objective

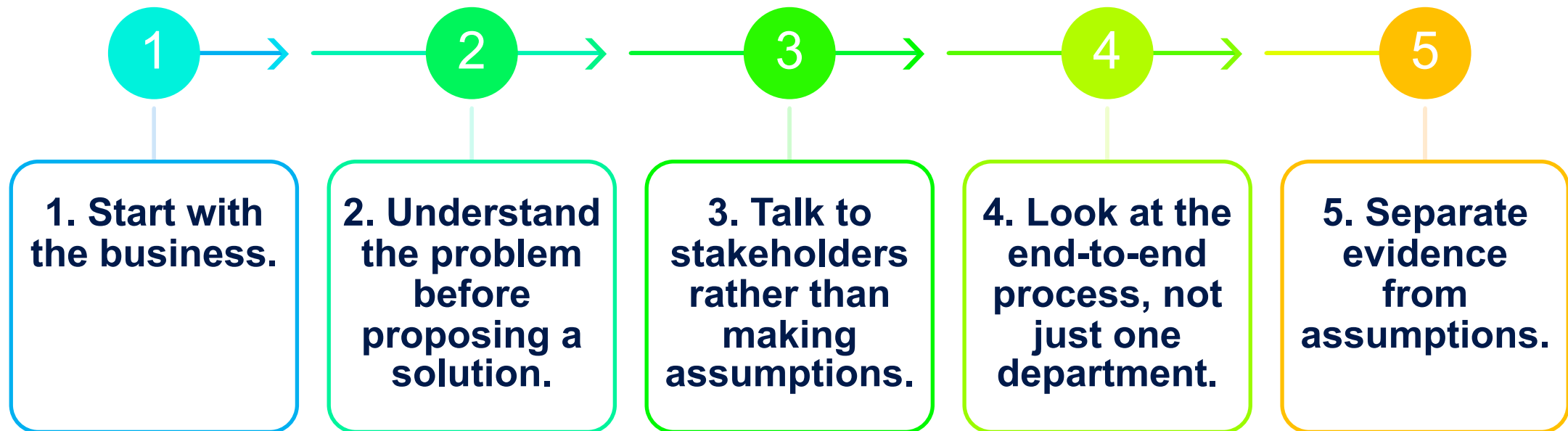
- **Artifact 4 — Initial Business Questions**
 - Key questions the team needs to investigate.
- **Submission**
 - Include the artifacts in the **Master BRD / Project Document**.

Week 1 Quality Checklist

- ☐ The team can explain what the enterprise does.
- ☐ The team can identify its major business functions.
- ☐ The team can identify key stakeholders.
- ☐ Each student has a clear Primary Investigation Focus.
- ☐ Each student has identified a relevant stakeholder.
- ☐ Each student has prepared 5–7 interview questions.
- ☐ Students have identified initial assumptions to verify.
- ☐ The team understands that **business functions are interconnected**.
- ☐ No solution or technology has been proposed prematurely.

Key Takeaways

- Remember the BA Mindset



And most importantly:

- BUSINESS FIRST → TECHNOLOGY SECOND*

